

Absolutely — **picture** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...it feels less like a **picture** and more like a window opening onto a calmer world.”

Here **picture** means **a visual image/artwork that represents something**, but in the sentence it is deliberately contrasted with **window**: Monet’s work feels less like a static representation and more like something you can visually “enter”.

Word family: **picture / pictured / pictorial / picturesque**

Base word: picture

Verb forms: picture, pictures, pictured, picturing

Related adjective: pictorial

Related adjective: picturesque

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **picture = visual representation / image — 圖畫；圖像；畫面**

Your sentence:

> “It feels less like a **picture** and more like a window...”

Here **picture** means:

> **a visual representation of a person, place, scene, or object, especially one created through painting, drawing, or photography.**

繁體中文：

把人物、地方、景物或物件以繪畫、攝影等方式呈現出來的視覺圖像

Natural translation:

> “It feels less like a picture and more like a window...”

「它給人的感覺**比較不像一幅畫 / 一個畫面**，反而更像一扇窗.....」

More elegantly:

> **「與其說它像一幅畫，不如說更像一扇窗。」**

So here:

> **picture = 視覺呈現出來的圖像 / 畫面**

1. **picture = drawing/painting/image — 圖畫；圖像；畫**

The broad core noun meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “It feels less like a **picture** and more like a window.”

「它給人的感覺**比較不像一幅畫**，反而更像一扇窗。」

Practice 2

> “There was a colourful **picture** on the wall.”

「牆上有一幅色彩鮮艷的**圖畫**。」

Practice 3

> “The book contains pictures of famous paintings.”

「這本書收錄了著名畫作的**圖片 / 圖像**。」

picture = 以視覺方式呈現人物、物件或場景的圖像

2. **picture = photograph — 照片**

A very common everyday meaning.

Practice 4

> “Can you take a **picture** of us?”

「你可以幫我們拍一張**照片**嗎？」

Practice 5

> “She showed me a picture of her garden.”

「她給我看了一張她花園的**照片**。」

picture = 用相機拍攝出來的照片

In everyday English:

> picture

> and

> photo

often overlap strongly.

3. **picture** = image shown on a screen — 畫面；影像

A major television/video/technology use.

Practice 6

> “The television has a very clear **picture**.”

「這部電視的**畫面**非常清晰。」

Practice 7

> “The picture disappeared but the sound continued.”

「**畫面**消失了，但聲音仍然繼續。」

picture = 電視、顯示器、影片等呈現出的視覺影像

4. **picture** = overall situation — 情況；局面；全貌

A major figurative meaning.

Practice 8

> “The latest figures give us a clearer **picture** of the situation.”

「最新數據讓我們更清楚了解整體**情況 / 全貌**。」

Practice 9

> “We still do not have the full picture.”

「我們仍然不了解事情的**全貌**。」

****picture = 對某個情況、問題或事件的整體理解 / 呈現****

This is one of the highest-value figurative senses.

5. ****the full picture = 全貌；完整情況****

Practice 10

> “One statistic does not give the ****full picture****.”

「單一項統計數字無法呈現事情的****全貌****。」

Practice 11

> “We need more information before we can see the full picture.”

「我們需要更多資訊，才能看清事情的****完整情況****。」

****the full picture = 某件事所有重要資訊綜合起來的完整情況****

6. ****the big picture = 大局；整體情況****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 12

> “Try to focus on the ****big picture****.”

「試著把注意力放在****大局 / 整體****上。」

Practice 13

> “Small problems matter, but we should not lose sight of the big picture.”

「小問題固然重要，但我們不應忽略****大局****。」

****the big picture = 不執著於細節，而從整體角度理解事情****

7. ****picture = mental image — 腦海中的畫面；想像****

A major abstract sense.

Practice 14

> “I had a clear **picture** of the room in my mind.”

「我腦海中對那個房間有一幅清楚的**畫面**。」

Practice 15

> “The description created a vivid picture in my mind.”

「那段描述在我腦海中形成了一幅鮮明的**畫面**。」

picture = 在腦海中形成的視覺印象或想像

8. **picture** = impression/idea of what someone or something is like — 印象；形象

A figurative extension.

Practice 16

> “The report gives a worrying **picture** of the economy.”

「這份報告呈現出一幅令人擔憂的經濟**景象 / 情況**。」

Practice 17

> “His description painted a very different picture of the city.”

「他的描述呈現出對這座城市非常不同的**印象 / 景象**。」

picture = 對某人、某事或某情況形成的整體印象

Closely related to #4, so I would conceptually group them rather than over-split.

9. **picture** = cinema film / movie (較舊式 / 特定語境) — 電影

A recognized but less central meaning.

Practice 18

> “It was one of the most successful ****pictures**** of its time.”

「那是當時最成功的****電影****之一。」

Practice 19

> “She appeared in several motion pictures.”

「她演出了幾部****電影****。」

****picture / motion picture = 電影****

Notes:

* ****motion picture**** remains formal.

* bare ****picture**** meaning “movie” is more old-fashioned or industry-related.

10. ****the pictures (BrE, dated/informal) — 電影院****

A historical/conversational use worth recognizing.

Practice 20

> “They used to go to ****the pictures**** every Saturday.”

「他們以前每逢星期六都會去****看電影 / 去電影院****。」

Practice 21

> “My grandparents often talked about going to the pictures.”

「我的祖父母常說起以前去****電影院看戲****的事。」

****the pictures = 電影院 / 看電影****

Register:

* especially BrE

* dated

Useful for recognition, but not a priority production sense.

11. **picture = verb, imagine visually — 想像；在腦海中想像**

A major verb meaning.

Practice 22

> “Can you **picture** the room with this painting on the wall?”

「你能不能**想像**這幅畫掛在牆上的房間？」

Practice 23

> “I can picture her sitting beside the pond.”

「我可以**想像**她坐在池塘旁的樣子。」

picture = 在腦海中形成某人、某物或某個場景的視覺形象

12. **picture yourself + -ing / in a situation — 想像自己.....**

A very common construction.

Practice 24

> “**Picture yourself** standing in front of Monet’s painting.”

「**想像一下自己**站在 Monet 的畫作前。」

Practice 25

> “She could picture herself living by the sea.”

「她可以**想像自己住在海邊**。」

picture yourself + situation = 在腦海中想像自己處於某種情境

13. **picture = depict/show visually — 描繪；呈現**

Another verb sense.

Practice 26

> “The painting ****pictures**** a quiet garden.”

「這幅畫****描繪****了一座寧靜的花園。」

Practice 27

> “The poster pictures several famous landmarks.”

「海報上****呈現 / 描繪****了幾個著名地標。」

****picture — verb = 用圖畫、照片或其他視覺形式把某人 / 某物呈現出來****

This use is less common conversationally than ****show**** or ****depict****, but fully current.

14. ****pictured = shown in an image — 圖中所示的；被拍攝 / 描繪的****

Practice 28

> “The artist ****pictured**** here is Monet.”

「這裡****圖中所示的****藝術家是 Monet。」

Practice 29

> “The building pictured above is now a museum.”

「上圖****所示的****建築現在是一間博物館。」

****pictured = 在照片、圖畫或其他圖像中被展示出來的****

Very common in captions/descriptions.

15. ****pictorial = expressed/shown mainly through pictures — 圖畫的；以圖片為主的****

A useful related adjective.

Practice 30

> “The book gives a ****pictorial**** history of the city.”

「這本書以大量圖片呈現城市的****圖像歷史****。」

Practice 31

> “The exhibition includes pictorial records of daily life.”

「展覽包括日常生活的**圖像紀錄**。」

****pictorial = 以圖像呈現 / 與圖片、繪畫有關的****

Register: formal.

16. ****picturesque = visually attractive, especially in a charming old-fashioned way — 風景如畫的；景色優美的****

This is an important family extension whose meaning has developed beyond simply “picture-like”.

Practice 32

> “They stayed in a ****picturesque**** village.”

「他們住在一個****風景如畫的村莊****。」

Practice 33

> “The lake is surrounded by picturesque mountains.”

「湖泊四周被****景色優美、如畫般的山脈****環繞。」

****picturesque = 景物非常漂亮、有特色，彷彿適合入畫****

Important:

> picturesque ≠ simply “having pictures”

It specifically describes attractive scenery/places.

17. ****picture-perfect = 完美如畫的；毫無瑕疵的****

A common modern compound.

Practice 34

> “The garden looked ****picture-perfect**** in the morning light.”

「花園在晨光下看起來**美得像畫一樣**。」

Practice 35

> “They chose a picture-perfect location for the ceremony.”

「他們為典禮選了一個**完美如畫的地點**。」

****picture-perfect = 外觀看起來極其完美、像精心安排的照片一樣****

Can sometimes imply:

> outwardly perfect

18. ****in the picture = involved/informed about a situation — 了解情況；在局內****

A common idiomatic extension worth flagging.

Practice 36

> “Keep me ****in the picture**** about any changes.”

「有任何變化都要讓我****掌握情況****。」

Practice 37

> “She was not fully in the picture.”

「她並沒有完全****了解整個情況****。」

****in the picture = 對正在發生的事情有所了解 / 參與其中****

19. ****out of the picture = 不再涉及；已被排除****

Practice 38

> “Once that option was ****out of the picture****, they considered other plans.”

「那個選項被****排除****後，他們便考慮其他方案。」

Practice 39

> “He is no longer in charge, so he is effectively out of the picture.”

「他已不再負責，所以基本上已經**不再參與其中**。」

out of the picture = 不再參與、影響或被納入考慮

Important distinction: **picture vs painting**

Directly relevant to your Monet passage.

picture

broad:
any visual representation.

It can be:

- * a painting
- * a drawing
- * a photograph
- * a digital image

painting

specifically:
an artwork made using paint.

So:

- > every painting can be called a picture in a broad everyday sense,
- > but not every picture is a painting.

For Monet:

- > Water Lilies = a painting
- > and broadly also a picture

But **painting** is more precise.

Important distinction: **picture vs photo**

picture

broader:

can mean drawing, painting, photo, screen image.

photo / photograph

specifically:

an image made with a camera.

> “Take a picture.”

often = take a photo.

But:

> “a picture in a children’s book”

may be a drawing, not a photo.

Important distinction: **picture vs image**

picture

usually a recognizable visual representation.

image

broader and often more technical/formal:

- * photograph
- * digital image
- * mental image
- * public image

For example:

- > image file
- > is more natural than
- > picture file

in technical contexts.

Important distinction: **picture vs illustration**

picture

broad visual representation.

illustration

a picture specifically used to explain, decorate, or accompany text.

> picture in a book

> = 書中的圖片

> illustration explaining how something works

> = 說明某事運作方式的插圖

Important distinction: **picture vs portrait**

picture

any kind of visual image.

portrait

specifically represents a person, especially focusing on face/appearance/personality.

> picture of Monet

> = Monet 的圖片 / 照片

> portrait of Monet

> = Monet 的肖像

Important distinction: **picture vs scene**

picture

the representation itself.

scene

what is happening/visible in a place or depicted moment.

> picture of a garden

> = 一幅花園圖像

> peaceful garden scene

> = 寧靜的花園景象

Important distinction: **picture vs view**

picture

representation/image.

view

what you can see from a particular position.

> a picture of the lake

> = 湖的圖片

> a view of the lake

> = 從某處看到的湖景

Important distinction: **picture vs mental picture**

Literal:

> picture on the wall

> = 牆上的圖畫

Mental:

> picture in my mind

> = 腦海中的畫面

Same core concept:

visual representation, but one is physical and one imagined.

Important distinction: **picture vs the full picture**

Literal

> “Look at the picture.”

= 看這張圖。

Figurative

> “We do not know the full picture.”

= 我們不了解完整情況。

Here **picture** has shifted from visual image to **overall understanding of a situation**.

Important distinction: **big picture vs full picture**

the big picture

= overall perspective, especially instead of focusing on details.

the full picture

= all relevant facts/information.

So:

> big picture = 大局 / 整體角度

> full picture = 全貌 / 完整資訊

Subtle but useful difference.

Important distinction: **picture vs imagine**

imagine

very broad:

form any idea in your mind.

picture

often strongly visual:

form a mental image.

> “Imagine a better future.”

may involve ideas, not necessarily a visual scene.

> “Picture yourself by the lake.”

strongly suggests creating a mental scene.

Important distinction: **picture vs portray**

picture

as a verb can visually depict something.

portray

broader and more formal:

depict a person/character/situation in art, literature, film, etc.

> “The poster pictures the city skyline.”

= 海報呈現城市天際線。

> “The film portrays him as lonely.”

= 電影把他刻畫成孤獨的人。

Important distinction: **pictorial vs picturesque**

These look related but mean very different things.

pictorial

= relating to / consisting of pictures.

> pictorial guide

> = 圖解指南

picturesque

= visually charming/beautiful.

> picturesque village

> = 風景如畫的村莊

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **picturesque vs beautiful**

beautiful

very broad positive beauty.

picturesque

especially:

visually attractive scenery, places, buildings, villages, landscapes, often with charm/character.

So:

> beautiful person 

> picturesque person  normally

> picturesque village 

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **picture** — visual representation = 圖畫 / 圖像 / 畫面

* **picture** — photograph = 照片

* **picture** — screen image = 畫面 / 影像

* **picture** — overall situation = 情況 / 全貌

* **full picture** = 完整情況 / 全貌

* **big picture** = 大局 / 整體

* **picture** — mental image = 腦海中的畫面 / 想像

* **picture** — overall impression = 印象 / 景象

* **picture** — movie = 電影 (較舊式 / 特定語境)

* **the pictures** = 電影院 / 看電影 (BrE、較舊式)

* **picture** — imagine = 想像

* **picture yourself** = 想像自己.....

* **picture** — depict = 描繪 / 呈現

* **pictured** = 圖中所示的

* **pictorial** = 圖畫的 / 以圖片為主的
 * **picturesque** = 風景如畫 / 景色優美的
 * **picture-perfect** = 完美如畫的
 * **in the picture** = 了解情況 / 在局內
 * **out of the picture** = 被排除 / 不再參與

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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picture — visual representation	以繪畫、攝影等方式呈現人物、物件或場景的視覺圖像
picture — photograph	用相機拍攝而成的照片
picture — screen image	電視、影片、顯示器等呈現出的視覺畫面
picture — situation	對某個事件、問題或情況形成的整體理解 / 呈現
full picture	把所有重要資訊綜合後得到的完整情況
big picture	不執著細節、從整體角度理解的局面 / 大局
picture — mental image	在腦海中形成的視覺印象或想像
picture — impression	對某人 / 某事形成的整體印象或景象
picture — movie	電影，較舊式或特定行業用法
picture — verb: imagine	在腦海中形成某人、某物或場景的視覺形象
picture — verb: depict	用圖片、照片或圖畫把某人 / 某物呈現出來
pictured	在照片、圖畫等圖像中被展示出來的
pictorial	主要以圖片呈現或與圖像有關的
picturesque	景物漂亮、有特色，彷彿適合入畫的
picture-perfect	外觀看起來極其完美、像精心構圖的照片一樣
in the picture	對事情有所了解 / 仍然參與其中
out of the picture	不再參與、影響或被納入考慮

For your original sentence

> “In a way, it feels less like a **picture** and more like a window opening onto a calmer world.”

The exact meaning is:

picture = 一幅用視覺形式呈現景物的畫面 / 畫作；作者說它給人的感覺不只是「一幅靜態圖像」，而更像一扇真的通向另一個寧靜世界的窗。

Natural translation:

> **「某程度上，與其說它像一幅畫，不如說更像一扇通往更寧靜世界的窗。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****picture on a wall**** → 圖畫 / 圖片
- > ****take a picture**** → 拍照片
- > ****TV picture**** → 電視畫面
- > ****full picture**** → 全貌
- > ****big picture**** → 大局
- > ****mental picture**** → 腦海中的畫面
- > ****picture yourself... **** → 想像自己.....
- > ****picture a scene**** → 想像 / 描繪場景
- > ****pictorial**** → 以圖片為主的
- > ****picturesque**** → 風景如畫的